

Captain Acquisition & Airport Supply

Head of Supply Decision Memo

Data cutoff: 30 June 2026

DECISION IN ONE LINE
Fix the largest document bottlenecks, improve late-night airport supply utilization, and use targeted acquisition only for the remaining gap.

Executive Summary

- Of **22,561 mature signups**, only **3,969 (17.59%)** reached approval. The largest sequential losses occur at **RC (5,433)**, **Fitness (4,481)**, and **Insurance (3,309)**.
- RC is the largest leak by volume. Fitness warrants **operational investigation: 2,428 Fitness drop-offs** are e-rickshaw captains, with the pattern recurring across cities. The data do not establish whether the cause is workflow friction, compliance, or documentation availability.
- Airport terminals show **40.24% unfulfilled demand** versus roughly **3% in non-airport zones**. The shortage is concentrated between **21:00–03:00**, with several airport hours reaching roughly **60–74% unfulfilled**.
- Of **60,000 airport trips**, **38,424 (64.04%)** had no return fare within 20 minutes. This rises to **70.09%** during 21:00–03:00 and **83.47%** for suburban destinations, indicating an opportunity to improve utilization before paying to acquire additional captains.
- **CAMP_WA_002 shows promise but is not causal evidence**. Among RC-stage captains, signup-to-approval (**A2O**) was **29.18% with WhatsApp** versus **25.03% without**, an observed difference of **+4.16 percentage points**. The difference is strongest in FOS and referral and nearly disappears in paid digital.

1. Acquisition Funnel: Where We Lose Captains

Stage	Captains	Conversion from prior	Lost
Signup	22,561	100.0%	–
DL cleared	19,967	88.5%	2,594
RC cleared	14,534	72.8%	5,433
Aadhaar cleared	12,988	89.4%	1,546
Permit cleared	12,170	93.7%	818
Fitness cleared	7,689	63.2%	4,481
Insurance cleared	4,380	57.0%	3,309
Approved	3,969	90.6%	411

Management takeaway: Only 17.59% of mature signups reach approval. The biggest absolute leak is RC, followed by Fitness and Insurance. Improve existing funnel conversion before materially increasing top-of-funnel acquisition.

What We Should Fix First

#	Priority	Evidence	Recommended action
1	Fitness	4,481 drop-offs; 2,428 are e-rickshaw captains. Pattern persists across cities.	Diagnose and simplify the Fitness submission and verification journey, especially for e-rickshaws.
2	RC	Largest leak: 5,433; 2,128 show potentially addressable capture/quality issues.	Improve RC capture guidance, real-time image checks, and document recovery.
3	Insurance	3,309 drop-offs; completion remains high once this stage is cleared.	Test targeted reminders and a simpler recovery path.

Illustrative upside: Recovering 25% of stage losses corresponds to approximately **371 additional approvals from RC**, **578 from Fitness**, and **750 from Insurance**, using observed downstream conversion. These are **planning scenarios, not guaranteed gains**.

2. CAMP_WA_002: Promising, But Prove the Impact

WA sends	Delivered	Clicked	RC-stage A2O
8,673	92.91%	41.15%	29.18% vs 25.03%

Observed difference: +4.16 percentage points. The campaign has strong engagement and a positive association with activation, but exposed captains may differ systematically from non-exposed captains.

Acquisition channel	Observed A2O difference	Interpretation
FOS	+5.35 percentage points	Strongest observed signal
Referral	+5.02 percentage points	Strong observed signal
Organic	+3.97 percentage points	Positive observed signal
Telecalling	+3.85 percentage points	Positive observed signal
Paid digital	+0.36 percentage points	Nearly flat

Decision: Run a **randomized holdout test** among eligible RC-stage captains before scaling. Test messaging around the observed **48–72 hour window** and measure incremental approvals and cost per additional approved captain. Do not assume the observed difference is caused by WhatsApp.

3. Airport Supply: Severe but Highly Concentrated

Airport requests	Unfulfilled	Unfulfilled rate	Peak shortage
136,814	55,058	40.24%	21:00–03:00

- Airport terminals have **40.24% unfulfilled demand**, compared with roughly **3% across non-airport zones**.
- The problem is localized: worst airport hours reach approximately **60–74% unfulfilled demand**, concentrated around **21:00–03:00**.
- This is not simply a “we need more captains” problem. The location and time concentration point to a **targeted supply intervention** rather than broad marketplace acquisition.

4. Post-Airport Utilization

Segment	No return fare within 20m	Implication
All airport trips	64.04%	Large unused post-trip opportunity
21:00–03:00	70.09%	Worst during supply-shortage window
Suburban destinations	83.47%	Weakest return economics

Suburban destinations also have the highest captain cancellation rates at approximately **21%**, versus roughly **9%** for city-core destinations.

Management takeaway: Improving the economics of the next trip can help unlock existing airport supply before adding acquisition cost.

5. Recommended Action Plan

#	Focus	Action
1	Fix acquisition leakage	Prioritize RC capture/recovery and the e-rickshaw Fitness journey; test targeted Insurance recovery.
2	Improve airport utilization	Focus on 21:00–03:00 and suburban corridors; test return-fare incentives, better matching, and cancellation reduction.
3	Acquire selectively	Target specific late-night airport corridors only where a residual gap remains; optimize for additional approved/active captains.
4	Validate	Use controlled experiments and measure incremental supply and cost, rather than relying on observed association alone.

Fix the funnel → Improve airport utilization → Acquire selectively

What I assumed & what would change my answer

Assumptions: The 15-day maturity buffer is sufficient; stage losses are treated as sequential funnel leakage; CAMP_WA_002 is observational; and airport “return fare within 20 minutes” is a trip-level utilization proxy because captain IDs are unavailable.

What would change the decision: A randomized WhatsApp test showing no incremental A2O; evidence that Fitness drop-off is primarily compliance-driven rather than workflow friction; or airport supply analysis showing the gap disappears after utilization/matching changes.

Data note: Data are synthetic. The mature cohort uses a 15-day buffer from the 30 June cutoff. CAMP_WA_002 results are observational and should be validated through a controlled experiment. Airport trip data do not identify individual captains, so return fare is a trip-level supply-utilization indicator, not a measure of individual captain retention.